

21
116

COW-SLAUGHTER

AND

VINOBA'S ORDEAL



IF THE COW IS PROTECTED, EVERY BODY WILL BE PROTECTED

Mahatma Gandhi

1. The more I study the question of cow-protection, the more I understand its importance. The question of cow-protection in India is becoming more and more serious day by day, as in it lies concealed the economic deterioration of the country. I accept that every religion deals with economic and political matters. That religion which opposes pure economics is no religion at all. That religion which opposes pure politics is no religion at all. Money obtained by irreligious means is to be discarded. political power, bereft of religion is demoniacal. There is no religion which can be divorced from economics. Individuals or groups are sustained by religion and perish by being irreligious. Accumulation of wealth backed by truth results in sustaining the people. But trade divorced from considerations of truth destroys the people. The gains from untruth are temporary. It can be shown by many examples that such gains proved harmful in the end.

In considering our duty relating to cow-protection, we will have to consider its economic aspect also. If cow protection is not sanctioned by pure economic considerations, it will have to be given up. Not only

this, the cow will never be protected, howsoever we may try.

2. For us, religion dictates that all living beings should be protected. But so long as we are not able to protect the most useful of the animals, we will not be able to protect other animals also. We have neglected the cow, and thereby driven both the cow and the buffalo to the door of death. Therefore I say that if we succeed in saving the cow by appropriate measures, we will then be able to save other animals also. But this can only happen if we realise the scientific and economic aspects of cow-development. We should realise that the cow is important because it gives us milk and bullocks for farming and draught purposes. It is valuable, even in death, because its hide, bones, flesh, and intestines can also be utilised. The cow is for us an economic gain, not a losing proposition. Today in many places the dead cow is either buried or sold for a song. How much ignorance lies in all this ? We abhor the practice of eating the flesh of dead animals, but we forget that the fault lies with us. If we can properly utilise the hide of dead animals, and realise the manurial value of its flesh, and utilise the bones and intestines of dead animals, as happens today in Nalwadi, then the question of eating the flesh of dead animals will not arise.

3. The question of Pinjrapoles or Goshalas is difficult ; we have a large number of them in our country. Probably in every town, we have one or two such institutions. They have also funds with them. Many are mismanaged. I have been constantly harping on their improvement ever since I have returned from South Africa. But till we clearly undersand what

is the real purpose of their existence, the money which is being squandered today on their maintenance will continue to be so done. Their real function is to look after those old, decrepit cows and bullocks, whose owners are unable to do so in their individual capacity. In the towns their looking after is a virtual impossibility. The function of these institutions is not to engage in selling milk. If they so desire, they can have a separate department for this purpose. But their real purpose is to maintain old and decrepit animals, and prepare the raw materials for a tannery (charmalaya). Every Pinjrapole or Goshala should have an up-to-date dead-cattle centre (Charmalaya). They should also keep pedigree bulls which can be of use to the public also. They should also have instruments for the scientific and painless castration of scrub bulls. They should also serve as institutions for the imparting of education in agriculture and animal husbandry. They can provide an extensive field for work for young men who have received higher education in agriculture and animal husbandry. Every Pinjrapole or Goshala should have one such expert. He will also get experience and education there.

Today the cow is standing at death's door and I am doubtful if we will be able to save it through our efforts. But if the cow perishes, we i. e. our culture and civilisation will perish with it. I am referring here to our non-violent rural civilisation. Therefore we will have to select one of two alternatives. Either we will have to adopt violent ways and destroy our uneconomic cattle, and in that event we will have to develop animal husbandry separately for milk and meat. But our culture and civilisation basically points

in the other direction. Our life is inextricably linked with those of our animals. Our rural population lives with their animals and frequently spend the night in the same building. Both live together and both starve together. Many owners feed less to their weak animals and thus exploit them, they also beat them and behave cruelly towards them. But if we improve our mode of work, then we can save the animals and ourselves otherwise we will be drowned together. And this is equitable as both must either survive or perish together.

The question before us is to get relief from our hunger and poverty. But today I have before me the question of the hunger and poverty of our cattle. The Rishis have given us an unfailing remedy like the arrow of Ram. They say protect the cow and all others will be protected. The Rishis have opened the gates of knowledge. We have to increase it and not to destroy it.

From "Gosevaki Vichar Dhara"



Prohibition of Cow-Slaughter

THE COMMAND OF BHARATIYA CULTURE

- VINOBA

1. I have issued two pamphlets regarding the need for prohibition of Cow-Slaughter in India. These must have been read by all of you. Hence nothing is left for me to speak on this subject. What is left is to work for its fulfilment.

2. I have given three sufficient reasons for people to understand why cow slaughter should be prohibited. First, it is the command of Bharatiya culture, Second it is ordered by the Constitution of India, as a directive principle of policy. And thirdly cow and calf is the election symbol of the ruling Congress.

3. Some people think that the Muslims will oppose this. Even Gandhiji is quoted in support of this. These gentlemen do not know that Gandhiji had said, that if there was contradiction between two statements of his, the later one should be preferred. Baba has not less knowledge in this respect than others, who claim to understand Gandhiji. Even so, Baba does not want to do things in Gandhiji's name. He gives expression to what he feels to be correct and true. When Gandhiji would have appeared before God, He would not have asked him what mistakes Baba had committed. And when Baba will appear before God, He would not ask him what mistakes Gandhiji had committed. There is a very interesting story in the Koran on this subject. Many people feel that perhaps the Muslims will oppose prohibition of Cow-Slaughter. I do not know whether you know that Baba has not

come across any Maulana, who has studied the Koran more than Baba. Baba can repeat from memory much of the Essence of Koran which Baba has written. The Koran has explicitly stated that the cow should not be slaughtered. The Koran says that we should take cow's milk, and for this we should be thankful to her. etc. etc. You can read all this in the Koran.

4. Some people feel that the Chirstians will oppose this move. In the 'Essence of Christian religion', which Baba has compiled, it is clearly stated as follows, by St. Paul.

"But meat commendeth us not to God. For neither if we eat are we the better, if we eat not are we the worse. Wherefore, if meat make my brother to offend, I will eat no flesh while world standeth, least I make my brother to offend."

(Corinthians : 8 : 8 : '13)

People do not read religious books. There is essence of Koran, Essence of Christianity, Japuji, which is the best among religious books of the Sikhs. All these favour the prohibition of Cow Slaughter. The last Guru of the Sikhs was Guru Govind Singh. Govind does not mean the killer of the cow. The name Govind shows how much respect Sikhs had for the cow. But people nowadays do not read, think, or reflect, over things and merely take Gandhiji's name. On the other hand Baba knows that the direction given by the Indian Constitution had the unanimous support of all the Muslims. It got the full support of the Muslims.

The result is that whether it be Muslim, Hindu, Bouddha, Christian, Sikh, Jain or Parsee, none is a beef eater, The jains have talked about eschewing completely all animal flesh. This is an advnnced thing. This will have to be done not only in India but in the whole world, This is a big gift to the whole world by the Jain religion. But this is for the future. Today the minimum that we can do is to stop slaughter of the cow. Nobody should be in any doubt about this.

5. Now I will tell you an interesting thing. The news about Baba's fast was published in the 'Maitri'. So, all 4200 issues of the Maitri were taken away by the government. What did Baba do, when this was in progress ? He watched and clapped his hands. He said 'Jai Jagat . Blessed are these people. They do not dare to allow to be published the news of Baba's fast.' "Yugadharma", "Gaonkari", "Bhoomi Putra" " Dharti-Mata" took courage and published the news. These news-paper world lacks courage, Hari Hari. What will happen if the newspapers cease publication ? We would not get food to eat ! But those people do not understand that even if the newspapers stop publication, everybody should know the facts, and then alone Bharat will get prestige. But these people do not develop courage. In Shankaracharya's time there were no newspapers. Yet the propaganda which Shankaracharya did has no parallel. There were no newspapers, during the time of Goutama Buddha, Mahavir and Jesus Christ. But none has done as much propaganda as they have done. Akhbar, (Newspaper) means A-Khabar, lack of news.

In short, there is the command of the Bharatiya Culture in favour of the prohibition of Cow-Slaughter, secondly, it is enjoined by the Indian Constitution, and thirdly, the cow and calf is the election symbol of Congressmen.

Question- You have dwelt on the duty of newspapers in the present situation, but we want you to explain how the ordinary man can effectively cooperate in the work of preventing Cow-Slaughter.

Answer- The two pamphlets which have been published should be distributed in every village and it should be explained that Cow Slaughter should be prohibited. You should visit the village through Padayatras. You can reach the villages, by motor car, railway or the bicycle. You should reach the village by any means. This is a work of two to four weeks. Our organisation is sufficiently extensive to cover all villages in this period.

Question : Probably the Government will declare prohibition of Cow Slaughter. But this prohibition is meaningless, if cows and calves are sent from the State where there is such prohibition to those States where there is none. Similarly cows should not be exported. Then alone the prohibition of cow Slaughter will work.

Answer : This is correct. As it is wrong to send cattle from one State to another, it is equally wrong to export them.

Question : Should we work for removal of Emergency or for prevention of Slaughter ? Which should receive priority ?

Answer : The questioner has not realised that Cow-Slaughter is the basic problem. And the Emergency is to go either today or tomorrow. This is not a situation of permanent nature.

Question : Prevention of Slaughter of Cow or prevention of Slaughter of both cow and its progeny ?

Answer : For the present I am committing myself to the Indian Constitution only. This has been interpreted by the Supreme Court. According to them the cow is completely protected, but the bullock has not received full protection. According to the Supreme Court unutilisable bullocks can be slaughtered. Baba does not accept this, even so Baba will not fast for this. The fast is intended for achieving the minimum. Even though Baba does not fully accept the judgement of the Supreme Court, he will not fast for protecting the bullock. He will continue to explain to the people that the unutilisable bullock also is worthy of protection.

Question : This gathering consists of people who do not eat meat; you should also ascertain the views of those who eat meat.

Answer : Baba is not propagating a completely meat-less diet. He is only advocating a beef-less diet. The Jains have advocated a completely meatless diet. This is their gift to the world. But this is for the future. The demand today is for a beefless diet.

(Speech delivered on 13-6-76 at the meeting of Krishni Gosewa samiti)

PREVENTION OF COW SLAUGHTER

The basic question of rural reorganisation

by

— Jayaprakash Narayan

1, This question can become complicated by mutually conflicting religious emotions. But if I understand correctly, it is not the dictate of any religion that the Cow should be slaughtered for performing its religious functions. Therefore if the slaughter of the cow is prevented by legislation, I feel that this will not involve injury to the religious sentiments of any religious community.

Can anybody argue that the prohibition of Cow- Slaughter is against any human value ? In reality the truth is just the contrary. The prohibition of Cow Slaughter is in itself an assertion of a great human value. The sentiment, which the Hindus have for the cow, is not based on any prejudice, blind faith, or as a result of animistic or totemic culture. In the early years of Bharatiya civilisation, there is evidence to show that the Brahmins and Rishis were also eating Cow's flesh. Slowly man's higher nature evolved. In this process our ancestors hit upon the great principle of Non-violence. They applied this not only to human beings, but also to all living creation. This way they identified the human Atman with the rest of creation. They selected the cow as the creature, which should never be slaughtered and this was the acme of the development of the human mind and its identification with the whole of the creation. It may be that this high principle has been reduced to a unintelligible practice, but merely because of this, it should not be scoffed at, by intelligent people.

Besides these human and moral aspects, the economic side of cow Protection is also very important. In this respect also I will say very respectfully that the view-point of our educated and modern elite is extremely shallow. The cow and its progeny, its dung, urine, and carcass after death is an essential element of our rural economy. Those who dream of mechanised farms or of so called scientific farming are living in a fool's paradise, quite unconnected with the reality of the rural scene. Except for irrigation, the future of our rural development is dependent on no other resources, as it is on the cow and its progeny. From the economic considerations also the development of the cow and its progeny is our great responsibility. It is true that the question of cow protection and its development, does not begin or end merely by preventing Cow-Slaughter. The Government and the people have to discharge various responsibilities in this connection, But it cannot be denied that the prevention of Cow-Slaughter is an essential element in this regard. It is wrong to try to by-pass this issue by stressing many other aspects of this question.

— From "Sarvodaya Samajik"



GOVERNMENT IS COMMITTED

to prevent Cow-slaughter

—R. K. Patil

(President, Sarva Seva Sangh)

My object in writing this is to explain the background of Vinobaji's decision to undertake a fast unto death from the 11th September 1976 unless his demand for a law banning cow slaughter throughout the country is accepted by the Government before that date.

2 The demand for a ban on the slaughter of the cow is very old. It is embodied in the directive principles of policy of the Indian Constitution as Art. 48. To the best of my knowledge, this Article received the unanimous support of all the members of the minority communities belonging to different religions,

Art. 48 reads as follows :

“ 48. The State shall endeavour to organise agriculture and animal husbandary on modern and scientific lines and shall, in particular, take steps for preserving the breeds and prohibiting the slaughter of cows and calves and other milch and draught cattle.”

It was later on interpreted by the Supreme Court in a case from Bihar, as sanctioning a complete ban on the slaughter of the cow.

This Supreme Court decision was given on the 23rd April, 1958 in *M. H. Quareshi V. State of Bihar*, and the Chief Justice summarised his findings as follows :

“.....So approaching and analysing the problem, we have reached the conclusion—

(i) that a total ban on the slaughter of cows of all ages and calves of cows and she buffaloes—male and female—is quite reasonable and valid and is in consonance with the directive principles laid down in Art. 48.

(ii) that a total ban on the slaughter of shebuffaloes or breeding bulls or working bullocks (cattle as well as buffaloes) as long as they are as milch or draught cattle is also reasonable and valid ; and

(iii) that a total ban on the slaughter of shebuffaloes, bulls and bullocks (cattle or buffalo) after they cease to be capable of yielding milk or of breeding or working as draught animals cannot be supported as reasonable in the interest of the general public.”

Legislation on this basis has been enacted in a great majority of the States in India, including those like Jammu & Kashmir, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Orissa etc. which have significant Muslim populations. Such legislation is now to be passed yet only in a few States, like Maharashtra (except Vidarbha), Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Assam, Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Pondicherry and a few States in the North-East of India.

3. In 1967, there developed a considerable agitation in India, and a demonstration involving about 7,00,000 persons marched in Delhi to the Parliament House, to secure fulfilment of this demand.

The Shankaracharya of Puri & Shri Prabhudutta Brahmachari had gone on a fast of about 65 days in support of the demand. Vinobaji had then expressed his great concern, and had expressed his full sympathy for their objective. It was as a result of this that the Govt. of India appointed a committee to go into this question. The terms of reference of this committee included the following.

'The committee will suggest ways and means for the effective implementation of the provisions of Art. 48 of the constitution, and also give full consideration to any suggestion that the constitution should be amended to bring about a total ban on the slaughter of the cow and its progeny.'

When this committee was appointed Shankaracharya was persuaded to give up his fast. Vinobaji was one of those who also advised Shankaracharya to break his fast, and he accordingly did so. This committee is yet to submit its report, though I understand it has made an interim recommendation suggesting legislation by the State Governments to implement Art. 48 of the Constitution as interpreted by the Supreme Court. It may be pointed out here that though Vinobaji is in favour of a complete ban on the slaughter of the cow and its progeny, his demand for a declaration by the Government is limited to securing the enforcement of Art. 48 only as interpreted by the Supreme Court.

Besides this, the Government of India have declared in Parliament many a time that their policy is to implement Art. 48 of the Constitution as interpreted by the Supreme Court, and they have Directed the State Governments to pass legislation to give effect to this policy. Such declarations have been made in 1970 and 1973 by the Ministries of Agriculture and also by the Ministry of Home Affairs.

4. It will be seen from the above account that the Government of India is committed to implement Art. 48, as

interpreted by the Supreme Court and have made declarations to this effect in Parliament on many occasions. And yet this policy has yet to be implemented by some States and a committee specially constituted to examine this question in 1967 has yet to submit its final report. The terms of reference of this committee show that the Government of India is committed to the implementation of Art. 48, and the committee is asked to consider extension of this article to the progeny of the cow.

5. It is probable that one reason for this delay is the possibility of some rethinking on this issue. It is a fact that there are a large number of cows, who are unfit either for giving milk or for breeding. The fodder resources of the country are also limited, and are perhaps insufficient for even the useful cattle. Under these circumstances useless cows and other cattle would be an unnecessary and avoidable burden on national resources. There is a view also that for those who eat beef, it is the cheapest form of animal protein. For all these reasons it is urged that this policy underlying Art. 48 should be reconsidered.

6. Now all these statements have another side. There is a difference of opinion as to the exact number of cows, who are unfit either for giving milk or for breeding. The fodder resources can also be augmented if Jwar & Bajri stocks are cut and then fed to the cattle. So far as animal protein is concerned milk can provide more protein if cows are properly fed and cared for. And all these facts are not new. The ultimate question can be 'Do you want to pay the price for your sentiment or not?' It is noteworthy, that all these facts are not new. They were before the constitution makers also. And in spite of them they decided on Art. 48 of the Constitution. And this decision was unanimous. Besides this decision has been reiterated by the Government of India many a time. It is, therefore, too late now to question the rationale of this

decision. The cow is specially treated and respected by large sections of the Indian population, from time immemorial, and is treated as a member of the family. It is therefore incorrect and improper to treat it on par with goats or other animals whose meat is eaten. Thus the legitimacy of the demand for a ban on cow-slaughter can hardly be questioned. If you want to dismiss this question as one of pure sentiment, you can do so. But let us not forget that every country has its own sentiment attached to some institution or personalities. In England and Japan you have the institution of the King. I understand in the State of Jammu and Kashmir there is a law against the felling of the Chinar tree. In India from times immemorial the cow has received a special place of reverence in India's tradition. In all such cases national sentiment has necessarily to take precedence over economic considerations.

7. Why has Vinobaji raised this question now ? Vinobaji himself has answered this question as follows. This is the 100th anniversary year of his mother's birth. He was taught by her to take his meals only after a ceremonial offering (नैवेद्य) to the cow. He has further stated that ever since he was weaned from his mother's milk he has subsisted on cow's milk. He will enter his 82 year on the 11th September. He feels that before his natural death he should serve the cow to the best of his ability.

8. Why has this demand been backed by the threat of a fast unto death ? This is not a threat nor should it be looked at from that angle. It is a position born out of the compulsion of despair. This demand has been made times out of number. There has been a nation-wide agitation for it. It is unanimously entered in the constitution. It is said to be the declared policy of the Govt. of India. You appointed a Committee to implement the article in the constitution and also to examine if the article should be extended to cover all cow's progeny. And yet you seem to be lukewarm about it and are perhaps

having second thoughts on it. What then is one to do if not decide that unless this is done India is not a country worth living in? It will be seen that this demand is very old. Vinoba himself has raised it many a time. Government also appears to be rather lukewarm about implementing this demand, even though it has been embodied in the Constitution. Vinobaji therefore feels that it is time Government took a final decision in the matter.

9. As already stated, many States have passed legislation in terms of Art. 48. And yet the cow is either slaughtered in those States or is transported to another State where it is slaughtered. That is the mere enactment of the law in those States where it is non-existent today would not be sufficient to protect the cow from slaughter. But Vinoba's demand today is just for such a legislation. Vinobaji's reply to this criticism is that in those States where there is no law or the law is defective, it should be enacted. And effective steps should be taken to implement the law where one already exists.

10. All this will involve close co-operation of the rural people. After all, though most of the cow-slaughter takes place in and near the big cities, the cattle go there from the villages. Therefore their transport to the cities from the villages will have to be prevented. This means that for every group of 10 villages or so, there will have to be provided a shelter for old cows and bullocks where they are taken care of and allowed to die a natural death. If necessary, their owners may have to be provided with some monetary compensation, so that they would not be tempted to sell them away to the butchers. Also a carcass utilisation centre will have to be located at the shelter place so that the hide and other by-products of the dead animals could be utilised. The shelter will have some grazing land attached for the use of the cattle. All this will involve regional planning, and a co-operative and community approach to the land and cattle of the villages.

We have been talking a lot about decentralisation and village planning, upto now. But now we have a programme of cow-protection and cattle development which could be the base for a plan and policy of the development of rural life

11. What we need today is a mobilisation of the total strength and endeavour of the people for their development. To some extent the system of political parties inhibits this process. If the ruling party's cohesion and electoral prospects are improved by dubbing the opposition as reactionary and non-secular, nothing can prevent them doing so. Thus the ruling party is permanently incapacitated from taking the co-operation of the opposition both within and without the legislature. How can this be remedied? By a common programme of action in which everybody can join. A programme does not become national only because it is pressed by the Nation's Parliament. It will become so only when it is accepted by the opposition also. This is the need of the hour, and also perhaps the special attribute of an Indian Democracy. Let the Prime Minister find other ways and means of consummating such an objective. This will give a new tone to democracy and democratic life. But this programme of cattle protection and development since it has general acceptance, will receive the willing co-operation of all elements in our public life.

12. These are all possibilities embedded in this programme of securing legislation banning the slaughter of the cow. We propose now to mobilise public opinion on this question. On the 11th August i. e. one month before the declared fast begins, we i. e. the Sarva Seva Sangh and the Goseva Sangh, have given a call for a day's fast and prayer meeting at 6 P. M. This will be followed by a Padayatra for a month in each Development Block of India. People could join the Padayatra in relays, but the Padayatra should continue for a month. Efforts will be made to see that the Padayatrees are representative of all religions and political parties and this programme

is not utilised by communal and other elements to bolster up their sectarian outlook. We hope that these two programmes, will secure mobilisation of public opinion on this issue. We appeal to you to broadcast this programme and this appeal to all and sundry in the country through the medium of the Press. I would like you specially to emphasise that if properly approached with vigour and enthusiasm, this programme can become the base for a complete and revolutionary reorganisation of our village life.



REVERED VINOBAJI'S INDEFINITE FAST

**Fast and Prayer Meeting on the 11 th
August all over the Country.**

**Padayatras to be organised From 12 th
August to 11 th september**

Brothers & Sisters,

You are already aware that Revered Vinobaji has declared that he will undertake a fast unto death from the 11 th September unless the Govt. of India declares its intention to undertake legislation for preventing cow slaughter. This decision has caused great concern and anxiety all over the country. It is therefore our duty to convey this information through all available means of communication and by word of mouth to all the people. If everybody passes this information to atleast 5 people daily this news can cover the whole country.

PROGRAMME

Sarva Seva Sangh and Krishi Goseva Sangh have joined together and drawn up the following programme till the 11th September 1976.

(i) Daily Programme

(a) Daily individual prayer for the acceptance of Baba's demand by the Government.

(b) Conveying to the people news of Vinobaji's decision.

(ii) Fast and Prayers on the 11th August 1976

One month prior to the 11th September, from which date Vinobaji's fast starts, i. e. on the 11th August, prayer meetings should be held at 6. P. M. Those who can undertake a fast should do so for the whole day. Members of all religions, communities should participate in these meetings. Any resolution passed at these meetings should be sent to the central office at Gopuri-Wardha (Maharashtra State), but these need not be sent to the Government.

(iii) Padayatra

These will be organised from the 12th August to the 11th September in all the development blocks in the country. There should be at least one Padayatra in each block, and the Padayatra should continue for a month, though people can take part in relays.

SUGGESTIONS

(1) If the Cow is to be protected both legal protection & people's Cooperation will be necessary. The prayer meetings should therefore invoke God's grace for both these objectives.

(2) Public participation on a mass scale should be secured in these programmes. No religion - Muslim, Christian or Parsee sanctions the slaughter of the cow. There is already legislation banning cow slaughter in all states, where Muslim population is in significant proportion like Jammu-Kashmir, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Rajasthan, Telangana, etc. When Art 48, which enjoins protection of the cow as a directive principle of policy, was incorporated in the constitution of India, it received the unanimous support of all the

members, irrespective of whether they belonged to Hindu, Muslim, or Christian religions.

(3) Even if the Govt. accepts the demand and makes the necessary declaration before 11th August the programme should continue till the 11th September, since the importance of public awareness on this matter is more important than even legislative protection.

(4) Vinobaji desires that this work should be done openly, with love and without fear. It should be borne in mind that this work does not assume political or communal colour.

(5) The June issue of the monthly magazine "Maitri" was seized by the Government, but it has been released now. "Maitri" has resumed publication again. They are bringing out special issue of 'Maitri' on prevention of cow slaughter by combining the July-August issues. If 100 issues or more are ordered, the issue which is priced at Rs. 1.50 per copy can be had for 60 paise. The money should be sent in advance, and the copies will be dispatched till the 1st August.

(6) All contribution should be sent to Krishi-Goseva Sangh, Gopuri-Wardha.

Post--Gopuri

Dist--Wardha: 442001

Phone : 365, 261.

Radhakrishna Bajaj

Convener,

Sarva Seva Sangh and

Krishi Goseva Sangh

Joint Gowadh-Bandi Samiti

VINOBAJI'S DECISION REGARDING BANNING OF COW SLAUGHTER

Addressing the Maharashtra Acharyakul Sammelan at Paunar-Ashram on the 25 th April, I had laid great stress on stopping the slaughter of cows in the country and desired that Acharyas should also take up this responsibility. A leaflet has already been published on the subject.

Talking to the Chief Minister of Maharashtra Shri Shankarrao Chavan, on the 17 th May, I had expressed my keen desire that there should be complete ban on the slaughter of cows in the vital interest of National development. I also indicated that if this is not done soon, I would have to undertake an indefinite fast for the purpose.

On the 29 th May, I declared before some constructive workers in clear terms that if an announcement regarding the banning of cow slaughter throughout the country is not made early, I would commence my fast from the 11th September, which is my birthday.

There are still 3½ months ahead. This period should be adequate for taking a definite decision in the matter.

31.5.76

S. D.

विनोबा

राम हरि

Price 50 P.



Publishers : **Radhakrishna Bajaj**, Convener, Joint Gowadh-Bandi Samiti, Sarva Seva Sangh and Krishi Goseva Sangh, Gopuri, Wardha. 442001

Printers : **Ranjit Desai**, Paramdham Mudranalaya, Paunar (Wardha)